characterized by genuine chemistry and mutual trust, despite differences of opinion on core issues.

In 1988 there was a meeting in Paris between the king and then-defense minister Yitzhak Rabin. This meeting did not yield results, and until early 1990 only lower-level meetings were held. It should be remembered that at the end of 1987 the First Intifada broke out, and in the summer of 1988 the king announced that he was washing his hands of the West Bank and the Palestinian cause. In March 1990, Mossad deputy director Efraim Halevy met with King Hussein in London. This meeting opened a new chapter in the relations between the two countries—the chapter of the First Gulf War.

As mentioned, King Hussein sided with Iraqi ruler Saddam Hussein. In meetings held on the eve of Saddam's invasion of Kuwait, we warned King Hussein not to allow Saddam to use Jordanian territory. This issue led to the next meeting between the king and Prime Minister Shamir, which took place in the first week of January 1991, about a week before the outbreak of the First Gulf War. At this meeting, the king pledged not to allow the Iraqi air force to use Jordanian airspace.

The Gulf War left King Hussein on his throne, and the Kingdom of Jordan suffered no physical damage. Hussein saw this as a great achievement and attributed it to the agreement with Prime Minister Shamir.

Throughout 1991, frequent meetings were held, the main subject of which was the upcoming Madrid Conference, which was intended to open another chapter of initiatives to end the conflict.

In meetings held in 1993, the king expressed his concern over the Oslo talks. We maintained that no significant importance should be attributed to them. When the signing ceremony was held on the White House lawn, the king saw himself as having been betrayed and deceived and as having his back against a wall, with Egypt and Saudi Arabia against him and the United States imposing a naval blockade on Aqaba. Prime Minister Rabin saw it as his duty to try and appease the king, so we worked on preparations for a meeting between the two, which took place in October 1993 in Aqaba with an Israeli commitment to maintain total secrecy. The king's explanation for the need for secrecy was that after the Gulf War he had only one ally— Syrian president Hafez al-Assad—and the disclosure of a top-level meeting with Israel could seriously damage Jordan-Syria relations.

The main bone of contention at the Aqaba meeting was the strategy of peace negotiations between the two countries. The king believed that minor